All Child Care
Solutions Inc.

Program Statement

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Home Child-Care

All Child Care Solutions Inc. provides parents with high quality daycare in Toronto, Durham Region and York Region. Our organization has done so for over 30 years. We are fully licensed by the Ministry of Education. Our qualified child-care providers invite your children into their homes to learn, play and explore the world around them.

The home is where children begin to learn, by observing and replicating what their parents are doing. From their first step, to their first word and until their first day at school, parents are the main educators of children. Our providers duplicate this natural home environment as they care for and encourage the children to learn.

All Child Care Solutions Inc. arranges child-care in the homes of independent providers who are licensed under the agency's umbrella. The children play and learn in a cozy domestic environment that is safe and nurturing. The providers follow the guidelines in Ontario Ministry of Education's *How Does Learning Happened? Ontario's Pedagogy for the Early Years*. This program statement outlines how our agency works with providers, children, parents and the community to ensure that children learn every day, according to the government guidelines.

Foundations	Goals for Children	Expectations for Programs
Belonging	Every child has a sense of belonging when he/she is connected to others and contributes to his/her world.	Cultivate respectful relationships and connections to create a sense of belonging among and between children, adults and the world around them.
Well-Being	Every child is developing a sense of self and health and well-being.	Nurture children's healthy development and support their growing sense of self.
Engagement	Every child is an active and engaged learner who explores the world with her/his senses, bodies and minds.	Provide environments and experiences to engage children in active, creative, and meaningful exploration and learning.
Expression	Every child is a capable communicator who is able to express himself/herself in many ways.	Foster communication and expression in all forms.

Core Principles - Discovery Through Play

Our providers ensure that the well-being of the children is their key priority in the home. That is, the children are safe, eat well, are nurtured and stimulated. When children have these basic needs met, they are more likely to self-regulate, and to positively communicate and interact with each other.

Play is the primary way that all children learn. Each day our providers create play-based learning experiences centred on the children's interests. These experiences are holistic and encourage learning in all areas of development – the physical, social, emotional as well as cognitive.

We view all children as competent, capable, curious and rich in potential. All of these qualities are essential for learning, and our providers encourage them in the children. Play is not just fun. It allows children to experiment, to make and test hypotheses, as well as to know themselves.

Children are naturally curious. We boost this by supplying our homes with books, toys and open-ended learning materials. Our providers rotate these frequently so that the children get plenty of stimulation. Traditional toys may include trains, dolls and building blocks. Open-ended materials may include cardboard tubes, cotton wool balls and coloured strings. A child can be creative and turn these into art, a space ship or a mermaid's hair.

What Will Your Child Be Doing?

Each day your child will do all the things that they want to do. This may include story-telling, playing with the blocks, opportunities to count and compare, to make pictures, sing and to make-believe. The children initiate much of the activities for each day. They are encouraged to experience the world by exploring, investigating and through self-regulating, inside the home and outdoors.

Local neighbourhood walks extends learning from the home, to the outdoors and reaches out to the community. As a learning environment the outdoors provides many opportunities for physical exercise, exploring nature, and for independent and cooperative games. When the weather is inclement and unpredictable, alternative activities for the children are provided. In addition, our providers may take the children on trips to the library and to the drop-in programs at the Ontario Early Years Centre.

Some of our providers have gardens where the children are encouraged to plant seeds and to watch them grow. Children learn about the environment and different forms of life by digging in the soil. They learn about the web of life from watching birds, snails and butterflies in the garden. They enjoy the freedom of movement; get plenty of exercise from running around outside and from using the play structures. Depending on their interest and energy level, children may spend many hours outside. Providers who do not have a backyard, take the

children for walks in the neighbourhood and to nearby parks. Many of these parks have splash pads, with supervisory staff, where the children can play in the water in the summer. In colder weather the children may still spend time outdoors to play, observe the changing seasons and to get some fresh air and exercise.

Our providers ensure that the children eat balanced meals each day. All the foods are prepared by the providers and are based on the *Canada Food Guide*. The meals always contain lots of fresh fruits and vegetables. The menu may change each month to encourage the children to try new foods. The providers eat with the children, encouraging them to feed themselves and to practice their social skills around the dining table.

Rest times allow children to reflect and consolidate their learnings. Infants rest according to their own individual schedules. Toddler and preschool children can rest up to two hours per day. Quiet activities are offered to children as they transition from rest to the afternoon playtime.

The Role Of Our Child-Care Providers

Each day our providers observe, facilitate, document and research how the children are learning. Each provider can care for a maximum of six children, from birth to 13 years, in their homes. The small ratio means that each child gets individual attention. Our providers are trained to watch how the children play each day. From these observations, the provider may suggest activities and offer materials that encourage the children to explore, experiment and use their imaginations.

In essence our providers' role is to:

● Establish a social environment that supports your child's autonomy and self-esteem.

● Establish positive relationships, friendships and resolve conflicts.

● Provide responsive care to all children while meeting their individual needs.

● Provide a safe physical environment.

● Provide new play possibilities through interest areas.

● Be an involved play partner.

● Foster, observe and document significant behaviour/developmental milestones.

● Incorporate the community.

What Will The Provider Be Doing?

We view a positive, supportive relationship between child and provider as fundamental. Our providers:

- Support you in your role as a parent.
- Provide a safe environment for your child and create spaces that are conducive to learning.
- Connect with children by being available, sensitive, responsive and caring. This way the providers build trust, and make the children feel safe and secure. Once this base relationship is established children are more likely to take risks, grow and learn.
- Watch carefully to determine what your child, at that particular moment, is capable of learning.
- Actively participate in your child's play experiences, and observe and document the milestones in your child's life to ensure age-appropriate development.

Program Assessment and Reflective Practices

Our providers reflect and assess their activities, programs and environment daily, to ensure that they are meeting the individual needs of the children, and the interests of the group.

The providers keep a journal for each child. In it, they document how the child is learning; the journal is shared with parents at the end of each month. Our providers may also take photographs and cellphone videos of the children, as these are other ways of documenting how and what the children are learning. The photos and videos are shared with parents so that they can try similar activities at home or just to see the achievements of their child. Providers will also observe and document challenges faced by the child and what strategies they will use to help the child deal with these challenges. These strategies encourage on-going communication with parents and help to keep them engaged in how their child is learning.

Our providers are competent, professional and knowledgeable. They attend frequent seminars and workshops to keep up with the latest changes and research in the child-care field.

The agency's home visitors review activities, program plans and pedagogical documents to ensure that they meet the agency's requirements. Our home visitors demonstrate pedagogical leadership by observing each home monthly and engaging in conversation with the providers and children regarding how the children are learning, what they need to learn and what is the best means for this learning to happen. Quarterly, our home visitors complete a licensing checklist for each home and its programs to ensure that the agency's quality indicators have been met.

THIS IS AN INFORMATION GUIDE ONLY (INTERNAL DOCUMENT) (NOT FOR THE HANDBOOK)

The program statement covers the following Ministry requirements:

a) Promote the health, safety, nutrition and well-being of the children – line 21-24
b) Support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents, child care providers and staff – line 88-99
c) Encourage the children to interact and communicate in a positive way and support their ability to self-regulate - line 40-44
d) Foster the children's exploration, play and inquiry – line 25-28
e) Provide child-initiated and adult supported experiences – line 40-44
f) Plan for and create positive learning environments and experiences in which each child's learning and development will be supported – line 29-37
g) Incorporate indoor and outdoor play, as well as active play, rest and quiet time, into the day, and give consideration to the individual needs of the children receiving child care - line 45-60, 66-69
h) Foster the engagement of and ongoing communication with parents about the program and their children – line 104-109
i) Involve local community partners and allow those partners to support the children, their families and staff - line 45-50
j) Support staff, home child care providers or other who interact with the children at a child care centre or home child care premises in relation to continuous professional learning – line 110-111
k) Document and review the impact of the strategies set out in clauses (a) to (j) on the children and their families – line 105-111